"People will think I'm crazy if they know."

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Where it often comes from

Stigma about anxiety, depression, trauma, and other struggles teaches us to hide them. Early experiences of being dismissed, mocked, or whispered about confirm the fear. We pay for the secrecy with isolation.

What Scripture teaches

Scripture shows faithful people in great distress: "I am weary from groaning; all night I flood my bed with weeping." "When anxiety overwhelms me, Your consolation delights my soul." "The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit." Paul writes, "Carry one another's burdens." "Two are better than one… if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!" Sharing wisely with safe people brings relief. Not everyone will understand, but God does, and many will.

> *"When anxiety overwhelms me, Your consolation delights my soul"* (Psalm 94:19).

Also see

> "I am weary from groaning; all night I flood my bed with weeping and drench my couch with tears" (Psalm 6:6).

> "The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit" (Psalm 34:18).

> "Carry one another's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ" (Galatians 6:2).

> "Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!" (Ecclesiastes 4:9–10).

Common self-statements

- They will see me as unstable.
- I have to keep it a secret.
- No one would understand.
- I will be treated differently.
- I will lose respect.
- I am the only one this happens to.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing others see me as either normal or crazy.
- Mind reading: Assuming I know how people will react.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling ashamed and concluding that I am defective.
- Fortune telling: Predicting rejection.

Challenging questions

- Who has responded well when I have shared something hard?
- What exactly do I fear they will think?
- Who are the safest people to tell?
- How common are these struggles, even among believers?

- What does Scripture show about distress and God's nearness?
- What small piece could I share first?

Truth summary

> Struggling does not make me crazy. Many faithful people have suffered distress, and God is near. I can choose safe people, share at my own pace, and find relief and help.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Depression, Symptoms of
- Anxiety/Worry
- Loneliness
- Confession
- Hardship

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Divorce
- Forgive/Forgiveness

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "People will think I'm crazy if they know"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"People will think I'm crazy if they know." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ Who has responded well?
- ☐ What do I fear?
- ☐ Who is safe?
- ☐ How common is this?
- ☐ What does Scripture show?
- ☐ What can I share first?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God is near to the brokenhearted.
- ☐ His consolation delights my soul.
- ☐ Faithful people have wept and groaned.
- ☐ Two are better than one.
- ☐ I can choose safe people.
- ☐ I can share at my own pace.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ Psalm 94:19
  "When anxiety overwhelms me, Your consolation delights my soul."
- ☐ Psalm 34:18
  "The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit."
- ☐ Ecclesiastes 4:9–10
  "Two are better than one, because they have a good return for their labor. For if one falls down, his companion can lift him up; but pity the one who falls without another to help him up!"

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Shared with a safe person: Each week, note one thing you shared and how it went.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.
  For example, Psalm 94:19 becomes: "Sarah can write: "When anxiety overwhelms me, God's consolation delights my soul.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Anxiety/Worry" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

Choose steps you can do safely. If there is violence, coercion, or fear of retaliation, seek private professional support before trying anything with the other person. In an emergency call 911.

- ☐ List safe people. Write two or three trustworthy people.
- ☐ Share a small piece. Tell one person a bit.
- ☐ Read Psalm 6 and 94. Notice the honesty.
- ☐ Seek professional support. Talk with a counselor. If you ever think of harming yourself, call or text 988 (U.S.) right away.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "People will think I'm crazy if they know": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Shared with a safe person
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~People will think I'm crazy if they know.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I fear being judged. You are near to the brokenhearted. Give me safe people and the courage to share a little at a time. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.